

SQL

Questions and answers from many sources — de-duplicated and organised by section

Questions	4
Sections	3
AI-written answers	0 (marked 📌 — the source had the question only)
Last updated	2026-09-30

Sources merged into this file

- sql_spark_notes.pdf — 4
- adf_open_questions.txt — 1

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Concepts & Joins (1)

Q1. What is the difference between WHERE and HAVING?

WHERE filters rows before grouping; HAVING filters groups after GROUP BY, so it can use aggregates.

Source: sql_spark_notes.pdf

Window Functions (1)

Q2. What is the difference between ROW_NUMBER, RANK and DENSE_RANK?

ROW_NUMBER gives 1,2,3 even for ties; RANK gives ties the same number and leaves gaps (1,1,3);

DENSE_RANK gives ties the same number without gaps (1,1,2).

Source: sql_spark_notes.pdf; adf_open_questions.txt

Query Practice (2)

Q3. Find the second highest salary from the employees table.

```
SELECT MAX(salary) AS second_highest
FROM employees
WHERE salary < (SELECT MAX(salary) FROM employees);
```

Source: sql_spark_notes.pdf

Q4. Find the second lowest salary from the employees table.

```
SELECT MIN(salary) AS second_lowest
FROM employees
WHERE salary > (SELECT MIN(salary) FROM employees);
```

Source: sql_spark_notes.pdf
